

STEELSTOWN PARISH NEWSLETTER

SUNDAY, 30TH AUGUST 2026

22ND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Faith • Prayer • Community

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 16:21–27

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of **surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love**.

Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice.

Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word PROFIT guide our reflection

True **PROFIT** is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is:

P — Pursuing God's purpose

R — Rejecting empty paths

O — Offering our lives

F — Following faithfully

I — Investing in what lasts

T — Treasuring our souls

When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind, so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.

Prayer for a New School Year

We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave.

During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. **Amen.**

Saints of the Coming Week

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Season of Creation

1st September – 4th October

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This year's theme, '**Living Water**', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

You are warmly invited to the streaming of World Council of Churches online service marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on **Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm** at **The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU.**

For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com

RSVP: 07711900420.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in **St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.**

All welcome.

Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN** for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

All welcome.



Padre Pio Prayer Group

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on **Tuesday 1st September**, starting with Rosary at **6.45 pm**, celebration of Mass at **7.15 pm** followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Visit: derryvocations.org



Donegal Group 173 – Rise and Shine Trust

Celebrating 40 Years

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating **40 years** of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter.

We are celebrating with a special Mass on **Saturday 26th September at 12 noon** in the **Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny**.

Mass will be concelebrated by **Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown** and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years.

We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: loughderg.org

All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino

A Day of Pilgrimage, Prayer, Brotherhood and Renewal

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner)

Visit: dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

Join us on **Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm** at **Murphy's on the Green**.

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity – Sacristan

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour

For application pack, please contact:

Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Telephone: 028 71262302

Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary

The September Men's Rosary will take place on **Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm** at **Market Square, Letterkenny**.

Everyone welcome.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September

For the Care of Water

You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention:

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run

The **Pink Colour Fun Run** takes place at **Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October**.

Details available at **cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run**

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Please remember in your prayers all those who are sick, bereaved, lonely or in need, and all those who have asked for our prayers.